Shashi Gowda

Software Craftsman ✶ Computer Scientist ✶ Product Developer

I want to work with people who are building a better world for humans. I like to build fast and delightful products that do their job and get out of the way of users.

I am a generalist with experience in **full stack development, product design, user experience development, performance engineering, and programming languages (my PhD field).**

shashi.biz ✶ shashig@proton.me ✶ 617-eight-nine-nine-4295
linkedin.com/in/g0wda/ ✶ github.com/shashi

Education

Massachusetts Institute of Technology *2018 Sep – 2024 May*
Ph. D in Computational Science and Mathematics
Thesis: Symbolic-numeric programming in scientific computing
Advisor: Prof. Alan Edelman **GPA: 4.7/5**

Natioinal Institute of Technology Karnataka *2010 Aug – 2014 Apr*
B. Tech in Information Technology
Was a **Google Summer of Code student 3 times** with StatusNet (LAMP), Sahana Eden (Python, Django), and The Julia Language.
Hobby projects included robots, web frameworks, opencv image processing, ECOG dsp research, probabilistic PL interpreters.

Work Experience

ZeroEntropy Inc (YC W25)
2025 Jul – present

Founding Engineer

Worked on building features on a high-availability, high-traffic SaaS. Worked on AI evals, and AWS Marketplace deployments of ZeroEntropy's reranker models. **Skills:** Python, Typescript, React

Sailplane PBC
2024 Aug – 2025 May

Senior AI Engineer

Developed a hierarchical planning agent with with high rate of success and reliability. My role: agentic AI dev, product design and engineering. Built the version pivotal to Sailplane's SAFE round. Lead development of many iterations of the agent and its UX.
Skills: Elixir, Phoenix, JS, OTP, LLM & RAG, agents, Gen UI, Product

Massachusetts Institute of Technology
2018 – 2024

Graduate Researcher

Built tools for differentiable programming and scientific computing. My thesis project Symbolics.jl, is a symbolic programming platform used as the lingua-franca of the Scientific Modeling ecosystem in Julia, supporting over **70 scientific simulation packages** with fast gradients of complex physical processes.
Skills: Programming Language Design, Program synthesis, Numerical Computing, Symbolic Systems, Compiler development, Performance Engineering, Julia, Scheme

JuliaHub Inc
2016 Sep – 2018 Aug

Principal Software Engineer

Built a high-performance, distributed analytical database, JuliaDB, achieving 1.5-10x query and indexing performance compared to pandas on various benchmarks. Built distributed indexed tables (now part of larger ecosystem) with performance beating Spark. Lead custom client deployments.
Skills: Analytical DBs, Extreme Performance, ML algorithms at scale, Distributed computing, Parser Generators, Developer relations

CSAIL, MIT
2014 Sep – 2016 Aug

Research Software Engineer

Built a distributed array framework. Built experimental UI frameworks for scientific computing users (Eshcer.jl). First tool to invent a server-side virtual DOM (now prevalent in modern frameworks like Phoenix LiveView.)
Skills: Distributed Linear Algebra, Functional Programming, Distributed Computing, Productization and Developer Relations